

Zealous Services Full Stack Developer - What to Learn

MUST Learn (Class A keywords with no direct project experience)

- **Laravel** – PHP’s most popular MVC framework (routing, Eloquent ORM, Blade templates, middleware). You have raw PHP + MySQL experience from ITJOBXS but not the framework layer. Bridge from Express.js: Laravel routes $\approx$ Express routes, Eloquent models $\approx$ Prisma/Mongoose models, middleware $\approx$ Express middleware. Build one small CRUD app with Laravel + Eloquent to see the parallels directly.
- **Django REST Framework (DRF) / FastAPI** – Python API frameworks. FastAPI is the closer bridge from your Node/Express background (async route handlers, automatic request validation via Pydantic $\approx$ Zod schemas you already use). DRF is Django’s more “batteries-included” REST layer (serializers, viewsets). Build one small REST API in FastAPI first (fastest ramp), then skim DRF’s serializer pattern.
- **Cron jobs & background workers** – scheduled/recurring server-side tasks (e.g. nightly cleanup, report generation). You have the adjacent concept from Inngest’s async background jobs in Vibe – the difference is cron runs on a fixed schedule rather than being event-triggered. Learn `crontab` syntax and one worker pattern (Celery for Python, or Laravel’s task scheduler for PHP).

GOOD to Learn (strengthens the application, not blocking)

- **Celery, Redis queues, message queues** – distributed task queues for offloading slow work (emails, image processing) from the request cycle. Conceptually similar to Inngest’s durable background jobs (Vibe) – the terminology and setup differ (Redis as a broker, Celery workers) but the “don’t block the request” pattern is one you already understand.
- **Role-based access control (RBAC)** – structuring permissions beyond simple auth (admin vs. regular user). You have JWT/OAuth experience via Clerk (Echo, Vibe, Aeris); the new piece is modeling roles/permissions in the database schema itself rather than relying on a third-party auth provider’s dashboard.
- **CRM/dashboard-style features** – data-table-heavy admin views with filters, exports, and analytics. Your Mixpanel dashboard work at Clink AI (5 dashboards, 35+ funnel reports) is a strong adjacent skill – the new piece is building the UI/backend for the dashboard yourself rather than consuming a third-party analytics tool.

Fast-Ramp Note

Your core stack (React, REST APIs, PostgreSQL/MongoDB, JWT auth, Git) already covers most of this JD’s day-to-day work, and your ITJOBXS internship gives you real production PHP/MySQL experience most React-focused candidates won’t have. Laravel and FastAPI are additional framework surface area on languages/patterns you already know (PHP, Python-adjacent async APIs) – prioritize FastAPI first since it maps most directly onto your existing Express/REST mental model.